DEVIKA SANTOSH

Experience Designer and Creative Technologist
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EDUCATION

CARNEGIE MELLON UNIVERSITY – Pittsburgh, PA **Aug 2024 - May 2026**
Master of Entertainment Technology

VELLORE INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY – Chennai, India **Oct 2020 – May 2024**
Bachelor of Technology | Computer Science and Engineering, with a specialization in AI and ML

WORK EXPERIENCE

Head Teaching Assistant - Visual Storytelling and Nonverbal Narratives **August - December 2025**
- Provided feedback and assistance on students' projects, managed team formation and attendance, headed weekly faculty-TA meetings, ensured tasks were on track for other TAs, assisted running the class.

AR/VR Intern - Bosch und Siemens Hausgeräte, India **June - July 2023**
- Collaborated with industrial design and UX research teams to visualize product design concepts, (Color-Material-Finish, Lighting and Rendering, and Consumer Pain Points) for household appliances using AR.
- Reduced the need for a physical prototype of all variations during the UX customer-testing phase.
- Explored VR in industrial design through physics simulations and visualizations of force, drag, etc.
- Participated in design thinking workshops, helped conduct surveys for UX research diary studies.

SELECTED EXPERIENCE

Producer - Mid-Way - a client project for the Heinz History Center **(View here)**
- Led a multidisciplinary team of 6 from concept to playable exhibit prototype in 13 weeks, managing external client and advisor relationships, rebuilding client trust, handling internal team conflicts, leading production planning, budgeting, procurement, and narrative development.
- Delivered a minimum viable product with easy potential for expansion for the museum's 2027 exhibit on Western Pennsylvania's amusement park heritage.
- Led playtest data collection with family groups and museum visitors, iterated in real-time between sessions based on observed user behaviour, and improved the exhibit based on our data analysis.
- Authored client handoff documentation for fabrication, install, and maintenance, including tiered budgets ($766 feasible / $1,160 ideal) with sourced vendors, material recommendations for preventive care of high-touch objects, public-safety fixes, playtest-backed design rationale to reproduce, maintain, expand exhibit.

UI/UX Designer - Little Owl Construction Co. **(View here)**
- Created user personas, journey maps, user flows, wireframes, prototypes (paper, low-fidelity, high-fidelity), and all UI assets for an experience that teaches middle-schoolers about career opportunities in the entertainment technology industry through creating their own animatronic puppet show.
- Designed and prototyped interfaces for five interconnected workstations, enabling students to complete collaborative, role-specific workflows.
- Also programmed the lighting station frontend to work with a DMX control backend.
- Iterated through multiple rounds of playtesting with users and close collaboration with developer.
- Built a reusable component library in Figma to improve design consistency and to pass on to future teams.
- Marketing and Branding: Designed logo and brand identity for team.

Narrative/Experience Design and Prop Graphic Fabrication - Titanic the Musical Pre-Show **(View here)**
- Designed a multi-phase pre-show experience for CMU School of Drama's *Titanic the Musical*, experienced by ~4,000 guests across 9 sold-out performances.
- Designed user journeys and audience personas. Ensured space design met accessibility standards. Created multisensory interactions that were inclusive for the enjoyment of guests with disabilities.
- Researched and designed emotional backstories for characters by curating props to be packed into their suitcases, writing personalized fictional accounts and audio-narrative voiceover scripts.
- 3D printed and soldered old handset receivers housing speakers, and custom object mounts. These interactables ensured no room for error from unpredictable guest behavior.
- Graphic design for vintage props. Designed logo, poster, and branding guidelines for the team.

Concept Artist - Boofinder - an alternate-controller game about ghost matchmaking **(View here)**
- An interactive gratitude wall exhibit for the Kindness Gallery at the Children's Museum of Pittsburgh, designed to hit SEL goals, so children can better recognize other people's actions and develop gratitude.

Experience Designer - CMU 53613 **(View here)**
- Worked in a team of 5 to create projection mapping, binaural audio recordings, artistic DMX light shows, an escape room in a space with embedded electronic sensors, and a dark ride.

Thank You For... - a project for the Children's Museum of Pittsburgh's Kindness Gallery **(View here)**
- An interactive gratitude wall exhibit for the Kindness Gallery at the Children's Museum of Pittsburgh, designed to hit SEL goals, so children can better recognize other people's actions and develop gratitude.

Building Virtual Worlds (CMU – Entertainment Technology Center projects) **(View here)**
- **The Cat Meow Spa** - **programmer** for a 2-week project, letting players bathe cats at a cat spa using Microsoft's Adaptive Controllers. Focus on interest curves and affordances.
- **Deer Stranger,** - **programmer** and **producer** for a 2-week project, building an intuitive VR escape room for naïve guests and predicting their behaviour in it.
- **Treasure Falls** - **programmer** for a 1-week rapid round, where two players had to use dance mats as controllers to collect treasures and avoid curses.
- **Two to Foxtrot** - **UI programmer**, **producer**, and **technical artist** for a 2-player asymmetric Xbox controller game, where players could see and move different objects in the world. Focus on increased guest throughput.
- As producer, coordinating the artist-sound designer-programmer pipeline flow. Oversaw daily progress staying on track. Organized playtests with target audience and subject matter experts, and retrospectives at the end of each sprint.

EXTRACURRICULARS

Livestream Director - CMU ETC Fall Festival 2025 **December 2025**
CMU Spring Carnival Booth - Helped create animatronic flowers for an escape room - won first place **April 2025**
Chief Designer – The Scientific Teen – international non-profit STEM magazine **2022 – 2025**
Content and Media Department Lead – HackClub VIT Chennai **2022 –2023**
Design Head – The Capsule, college magazine, VIT Chennai **2021 –2022**

COMMENDATIONS

Pittsburgh Global Game Jam 2026 - Best theming and narrative **(View here)**
Environment art, graphic design for a game inspired by Edgar Allan Poe's The Masque of the Red Death.
Invitational TMU Thrill Design Competition 2025 - Presented by Universal Creative - experience designer and concept artist, won commendations for artistic illustration and technical communication
Gradient, Android Club UI Ideathon 2022 - Second place winner **(View here)**

SKILLS

Programming	Python, Java, C#, SQL, Web Development, Three.js, Arduino
3D Software, XR, Game Development	Blender, Autodesk Maya, Unity, Unreal Engine
Art and Design	UI/UX Design, Design Thinking, Illustration, Figma, Procreate
Experience Design	Projection Mapping, HeavyM, TouchDesigner, MediaPipe
Adobe	Illustrator, Photoshop, InDesign, Premiere Pro, Substance Painter
Management	Perforce, Jira, Microsoft Office
Fabrication	Laser Cutting, 3D Printing, Rapid Prototyping
Others	Narrative Design, Experience Design, Content Writing, User Research

RELEVANT COURSEWORK

Experience Design, Introduction to Physical Fabrication, Learning in Museums, Introduction to 3D Animation, Google - UX Design Professional Certificate, Google - Foundations of Project Management, Kile Ozier's summer Experience Design masterclass